Day 63 - Coles, Mystery Cabin, Don Richards, Kemble Wetland, Cedar Point, MapleCross Ridge, Birch Camp

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Sydenham section · hike 85 · Kemble Rock & Kemble Wetland (BTC nature reserve)

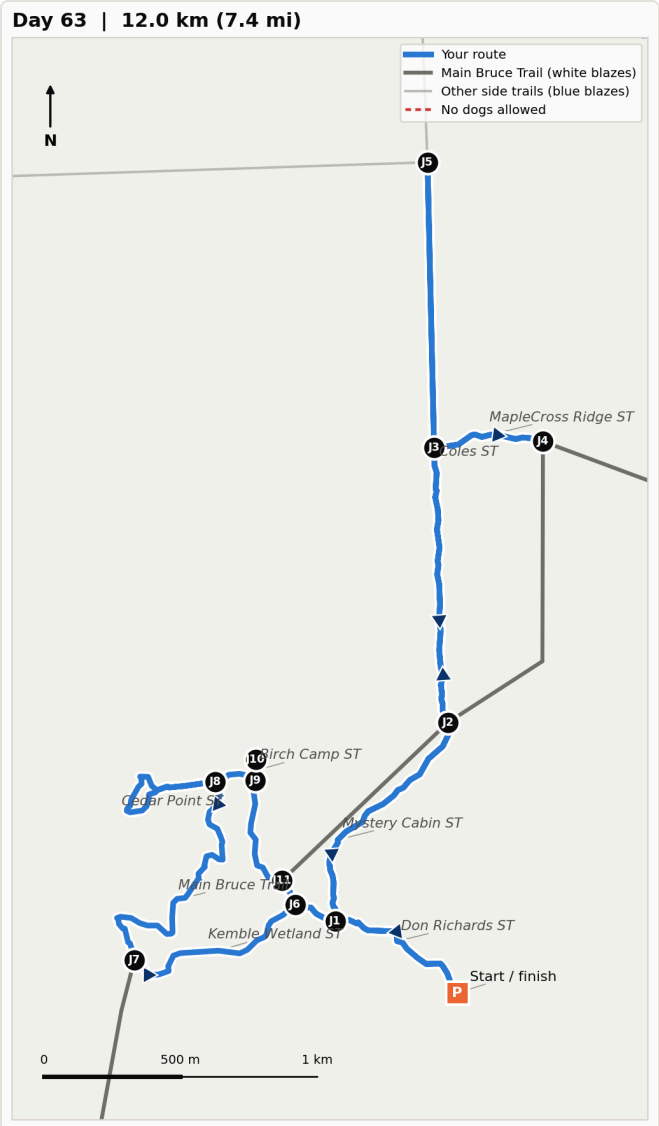
12.0 km / 7.4 mi	~3.8 h	5.8 km new	172 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

Park (P): Roadside parking on the shoulder of Cole's Side Rd, just as it turns into a logging road. Do not block the logging road. Google Maps. **Free**

Navigate: import *day63_hike085.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Coles Side Trail (2.1 km); Mystery Cabin Side Trail (1.0 km); Don Richards Side Trail (0.9 km); Kemble Wetland Side Trail (0.7 km); Cedar Point Side Trail (0.6 km); MapleCross Ridge Side Trail (0.4 km); Birch Camp Side Trail (0.1 km)

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** Roadside parking on the shoulder of Cole's Side Rd, where it turns into a logging road. Don't block the logging road. In April 2026 the BTC reported Coles Road closed to traffic because of flooding, so in wet seasons check conditions before you drive up.
- **Kemble trail network:** This web of side trails opened in 2019 across 316 acres of Bruce Trail Conservancy land. A BTC club hike rated it moderate, with some hills, poor footing and muddy sections, crevices, and mature cedar and hardwood forest. A guidebook rates the loops moderate to strenuous.
- **Cliff edge and crevices:** Part of the main Bruce Trail here follows a narrow ledge along the cliff face, and a guidebook warns that many crevices lie above the cliff edge. Keep Zappy on a short leash and close to you.
- **Cedar Point Side Trail:** A short loop to a lookout over a marsh and an area of shallow open water.
- **Kemble Wetland Side Trail:** It leads to a clearing at the edge of a large wetland, through meadow, hawthorn thicket and mature hardwood forest. Watch for a big fallen tree with a hole cut through it. Club hikers skip this trail when it's too wet.
- **Mystery Cabin and Coles side trails:** The Mystery Cabin route passes the ruins of a small cabin overlooking a view. We didn't find descriptions of the MapleCross Ridge or Birch Camp side trails.
- **Length:** At 12.5 km this is a long day. The many short loops add up, so bring water and snacks for you and Zappy.

Parking options

No other official Bruce Trail parking lies within about 1 km of this route. If you need to stop early, turn back the way you came; the GPS track records what you covered, and the website shows what is left.

Can't do it all in one go? Split it into two shorter outings: **Outing 1** from the planned parking (P): 8.2 km / 5.1 mi, covering Coles, Don Richards, MapleCross Ridge, Mystery Cabin. **Outing 2** from the planned parking (P) again: 5.2 km / 3.2 mi, covering Birch Camp, Cedar Point, Don Richards, Kemble Wetland. The website's map shows which parts are already done.

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Roadside parking on the shoulder of Cole's Side Rd, just as it turns into a logging road. Head north-west on the blue-blazed Don Richards Side Trail.
0.6	0.4	J1: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Mystery Cabin Side Trail, heading north. (the blue-blazed Don Richards Side Trail goes off ahead.)
1.5	1.0	J2: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Coles Side Trail, heading north-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left; the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.) The next 1.0 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
2.6	1.6	J3: Turn right onto the blue-blazed MapleCross Ridge Side Trail, heading east. (the blue-blazed Coles Side Trail goes off ahead.)
3.0	1.9	J4: Turnaround point. The side trail meets the white-blazed main Bruce Trail here. Turn around and retrace your steps.
3.4	2.1	J3: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Coles Side Trail, heading north. (the Coles Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.) The next 3.1 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
4.5	2.8	J5: Turnaround point. Turn around and retrace your steps.
5.5	3.4	J3: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the Coles Side Trail, heading south. (the MapleCross Ridge Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
6.5	4.1	J2: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Mystery Cabin Side Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right; the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
7.5	4.6	J1: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Don Richards Side Trail, heading west. (the Don Richards Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
7.6	4.7	J6: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Kemble Wetland Side Trail, heading south-west. (the blue-blazed Don Richards Side Trail goes off on your right.)
8.4	5.2	J7: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
9.5	5.9	J8: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Cedar Point Side Trail, heading west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.) This is a short excursion (about 850 m in all): walk the whole Cedar Point Side Trail, including the short loop or branch near its end (see the map), and come back to this junction.
10.3	6.4	J8: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading east. (the main Bruce Trail you already walked goes off on your right.)
10.5	6.5	J9: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Birch Camp Side Trail, heading north. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
10.6	6.6	J10: End of the Birch Camp Side Trail. Turn around and retrace your steps.
10.7	6.6	J9: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south. (the main Bruce Trail you already walked goes off on your right.)
11.1	6.9	J11: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Don Richards Side Trail, heading south-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
11.2	7.0	J6: Junction. Turn left to stay on the Don Richards Side Trail, heading east. (the Kemble Wetland Side Trail you already walked goes off on your right.)
11.4	7.1	J1: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the Don Richards Side Trail, heading east. (the Mystery Cabin Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
12.0	7.4	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Bruce Trail Conservancy trail notices and hike listings and a published Kemble Rock guidebook chapter.